

# Constrained Delaunay tetrahedrisation refinement

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Royer Max

ENS of Lyon

September 3, 2025

# Outline

## Introduction

- Motivation

- Constrained Delaunay tetrahedrisation

- State of the art

## The refinement algorithm

- General principle

- Edge collapse

- A new operation

## Results

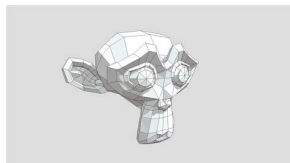
- Comparison to TetGen

## Conclusion

## Appendix

# Big picture

## Constrained Delaunay tetrahedrisation



A 3D model  
(not necessarily  
tetrahedrised)



The **Delaunay** tetrahedrised  
model (*i.e.* a set of tetrahedra)

# Applications

Physics-based simulations:

- ▶ Finite element method
- ▶ Solutions of partial differential equations
- ▶ Ray tracing



Figure: Example of finite element method

# Problem

Need good quality and regularity of the mesh

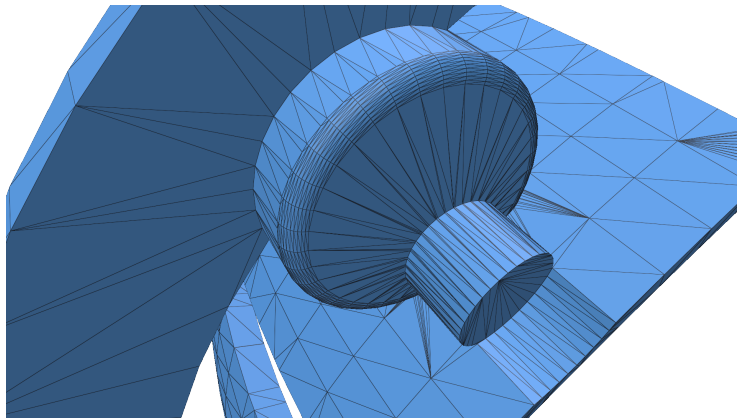


Figure: Example of a bad model

# Constrained Delaunay triangulation

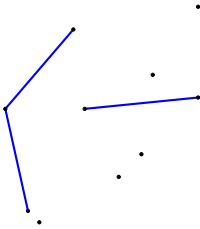


Figure: Edge constraints for Delaunay triangulation

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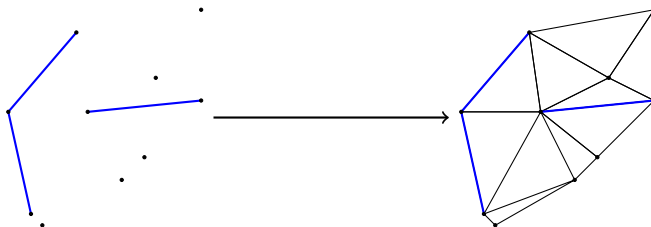


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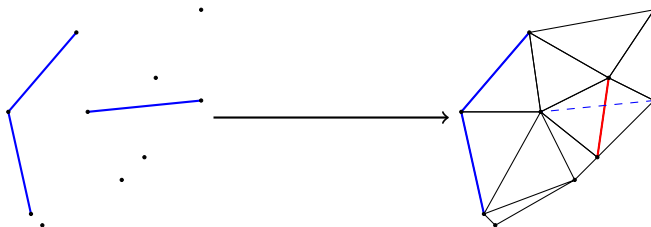


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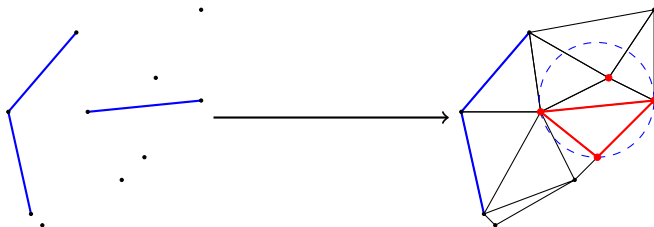


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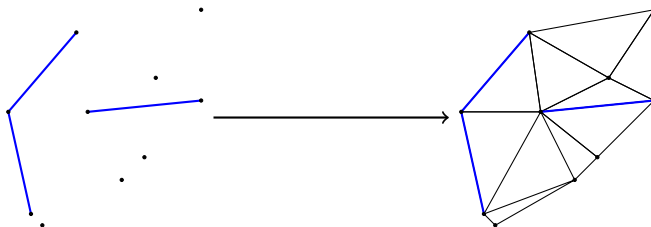


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An edge is either a constraint or is locally Delaunay

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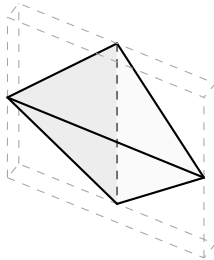


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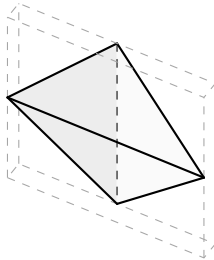


Figure: Example of sliver

- ▶ Constrained Delaunay tetrahedrisation are not always possible

# TetGen [Si, 2015]

Already existing software

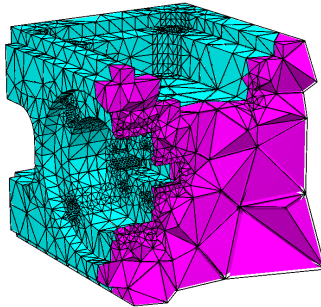


Figure: A model tetrahedrized by TetGen

- Not so robust, crashes on some models

# Tetrahedral meshing in the wild (Tetwild) [Hu, 2018]

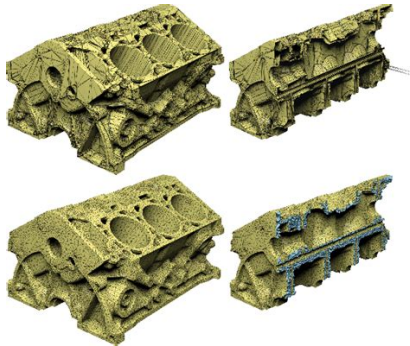


Figure: A model tetrahedrized by Tetwild

- Not strict on boundary



# Quality measure

How to say if a tetrahedron is "*good*"?

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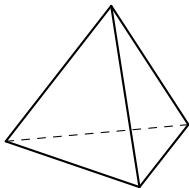
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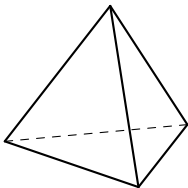


Minimized on a regular  
tetrahedron (= 3)

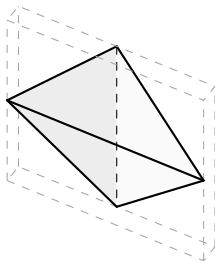
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How to say if a tetrahedron is "good"?

► *Dirichlet* energy :  $\frac{\text{Tr}(JJ^T)}{\det(J)^{\frac{2}{3}}}$



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Big value on bad tetrahedron  
( $\sim 10^3 - 10^4$ )

## Local operation pass

Figure: Local operation scheme

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Simulation pass

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Compute impacted elements

Update  $Q$

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## Optimization Pass

Edge split pass

Edge collapse pass

Edge swap pass

Face swap pass

Vertex smoothing pass

Tetrahedron collapse pass

Figure: Optimization process scheme

# Overview

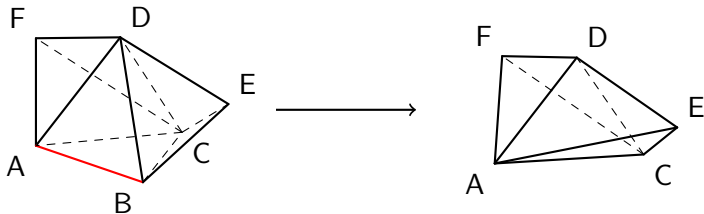


Figure: Example of collapsing an edge

# Simulation

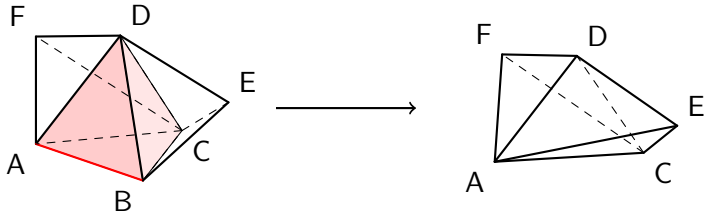


Figure: Impacted tetrahedra by an edge collapse

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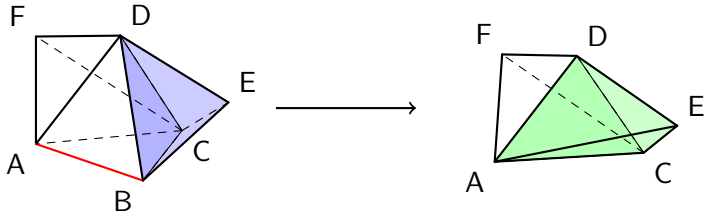


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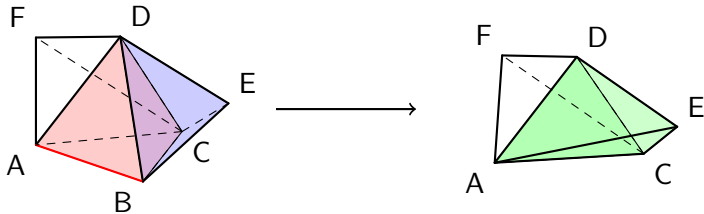


Figure: Impacted tetrahedra by an edge collapse

**Quality before:**

Max on **removed elements**  $\cup$   
**unupdated elements**

**Quality after:**

Max on **updated elements**



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Collapsing  $e := (u, v)$  can break topology

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$$\text{Lk}(e) = \text{Lk}(u) \cap \text{Lk}(v) \quad (\text{Link condition})$$

- ▶  $\text{Lk}(u) = \text{neighbours of } u$
- ▶  $\text{Lk}(e) = \text{vertices sharing a face with } e$

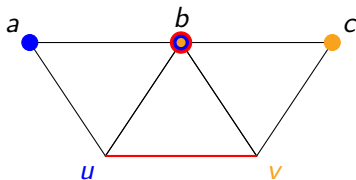


Figure: Respected link condition

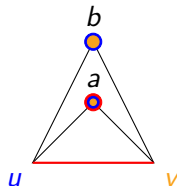


Figure: Not respected link condition

# Get rid of slivers

Some slivers resisted known operation  $\Rightarrow$  Create a new operation

Figure: Tetrahedron collapsing process

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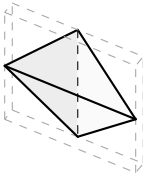


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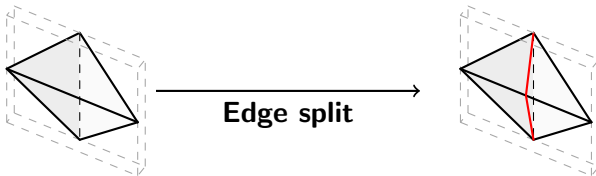


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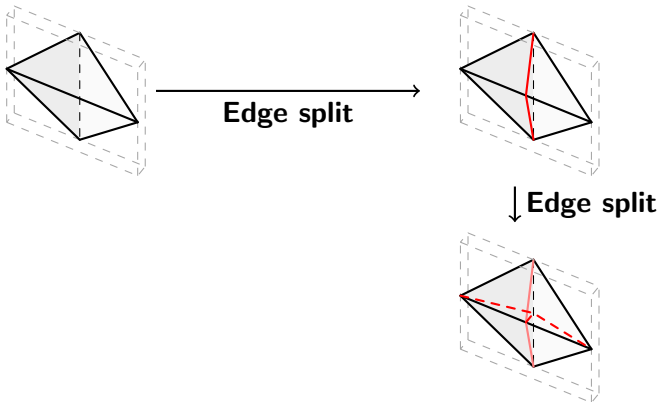


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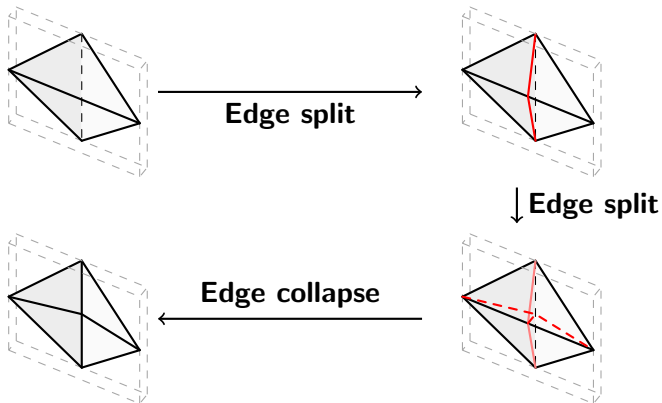


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# Comparison

|       | CDT | TetGen |
|-------|-----|--------|
| Fails | 0%  | 25,2%  |

Table: Stats on the smallest 500 models of *Thingi10k*

► + More robust



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| Best on time | 14,44% | 85,56% |

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Table: Stats on the smallest 500 models of *Thingi10k*

- ▶ + More robust
- ▶ - Slower
- ▶ - Slightly less efficient

|              | CDT    | TetGen |
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| Best on time | 14,44% | 85,56% |
| Best on mean | 5,35%  | 94,65% |
| Best on max  | 20,59% | 79,41% |

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# Future work and improvements

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  - ▶ To remove needles
- ▶ Make some operations finer
  - ▶ Split edge not always at midpoint

# References



H. Si.

*TetGen, a Delaunay-Based Quality Tetrahedral Mesh Generator.*

*ACM Trans. on Mathematical Software*, 41 (2), Article 11, 2015.



Y. Hu, Q. Zhou, X. Gao, A. Jacobson, D. Zorin, D. Panozzo.  
*Tetrahedral Meshing in the Wild.*

*ACM Trans. Graph.* 37, 4, Article 60, 2018.

# Delaunay condition

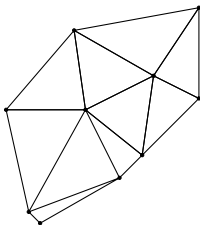


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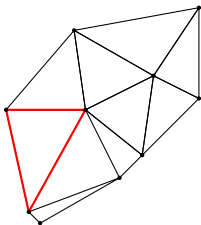


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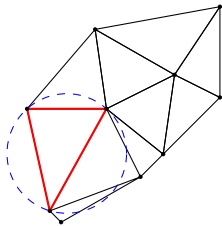


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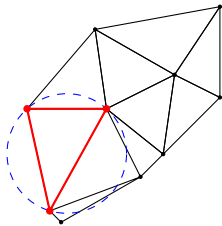
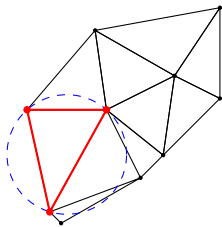


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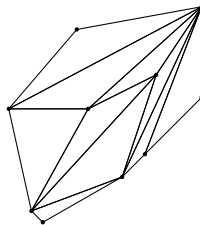
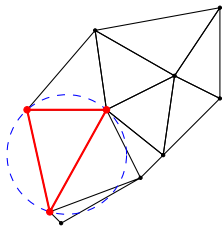
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Respected

Figure: Example for Delaunay condition

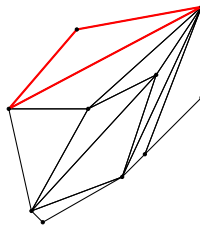
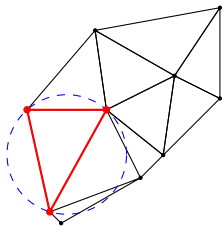
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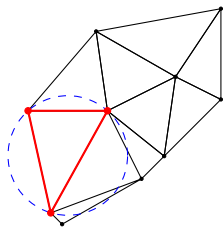
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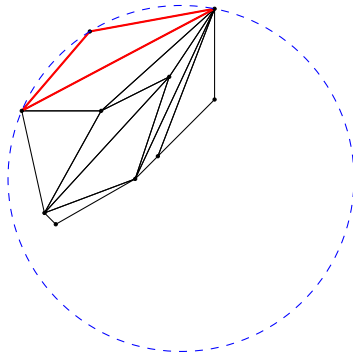
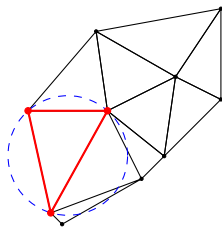


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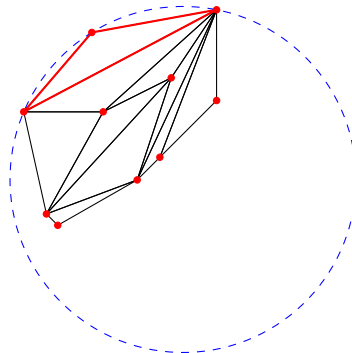
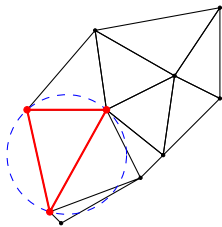
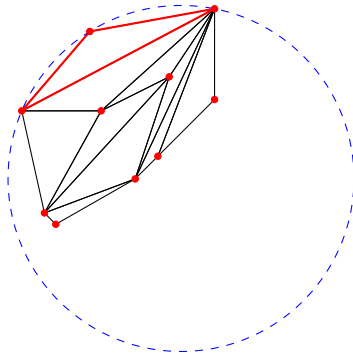


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# Delaunay condition



Respected



Not respected

Figure: Example for Delaunay condition



# An example

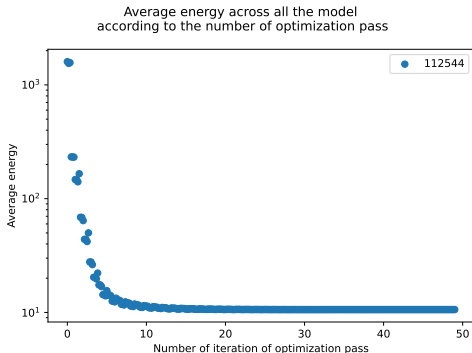
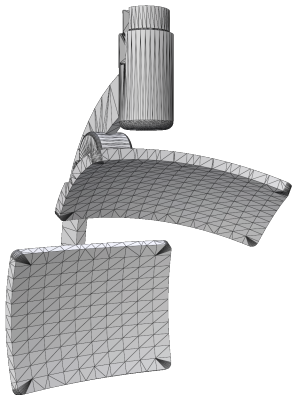


Figure: The model 112544

# Evolution of the distribution

